

8.5 Keyboard Destroyers!

The games we used to play on the ZX Spectrum back in 1987 or so were pretty good, considering the Spectrum had 48K of RAM and no hard disk. In fact, it's amazing how game developers back then could squeeze such good games into that much of space. But as always, there were the good and the bad, and while we won't go into too much detail, we should mention something retarded we used to do—play the so-called 'Keyboard Destroyer' games.



The ZX Spectrum

The most popular amongst these was a game called *Daly Thompson's Super Test*. As far as we can recall, it was a decathlon of sorts. All the sports had the same basic tactic: hit the keyboard as fast (and therefore as hard) as possible. Allow us to explain.

The first sport was a 100-metre sprint. To make your runner run faster, you had to press the keys as fast as possible. The second was a skiing contest: to make for a perfect landing, you had to press the keys as fast as possible when your character was making the jump off the cliff. The third sport was swimming; to swim faster, you had to press the keys as fast as you could... you get the idea!

The game built up a terrific feeling of brotherhood and unity amongst those present. There would be one person playing it, and the others would cheer him on—and you guessed it, the cheers mostly consisted of "Harder! Harder! Harder!" Talk about retarded!